Porter-Style Delivery Platform: Idea Brief and Business Concept

Document 1 of the pack | Version 0.4 (draft, updated with competitive research) | Market: Melbourne, Victoria Scope: Point-to-point delivery marketplace only. The quick-commerce ideas are parked (see Section 12).
Labels used: FACT (supported), ASSUMPTION, RISK, OPPORTUNITY, RECOMMENDATION, OPEN QUESTION. No new market research has been done for this version. Market figures from earlier material are excluded until sourced.

---

1. The idea in one paragraph

An app-based marketplace where anyone, whether a business or an individual, can book the delivery of any item, from a document to a couch. The platform recommends the right vehicle (bike, car, van/ute, truck), shows an instant price, matches a nearby independent driver, and tracks the job through to photo proof of delivery. Drivers join the platform like Uber drivers: they sign up, accept jobs they want, and earn per completed delivery. They are not employees and are not recruited onto a payroll.

2. Problem

Who	Problem today
Small businesses (furniture, florists, parts suppliers, online sellers)	Premium couriers are costly, and ad hoc drivers have no price transparency, tracking, or paperwork
Individuals	Moving a bulky item (marketplace purchase, student move) means phoning around, haggling, or borrowing a ute
Drivers with a vehicle	Income is inconsistent and depends on brokers, referrals, or chasing jobs

ASSUMPTION: These pains are strong enough for people to switch to an app. This must be validated through customer interviews and a manual pilot.

3. Proposed solution and value proposition

- Right-sized vehicle: The customer describes the item and the platform suggests the vehicle.
- Instant, transparent quote: No phone calls and no surprise fees.
- Tracked job with proof of delivery: Live status, photo evidence, and a receipt.
- For drivers: Flexible jobs, a clear earnings preview, and fast payouts.

4. Users

User	Role	Needs
Business customer	Books regular or one-off deliveries	Reliability, invoicing, repeat booking, proof of delivery
Individual customer	Books occasional jobs	Simple booking, fair price, trust
Driver (independent contractor)	Fulfils jobs	Steady jobs, fair pay, easy app, clear rules
Platform admin	Operates the marketplace	Dispatch override, onboarding checks, disputes, pricing control

DECISION (approach): The product is open to everyone: consumers and businesses can both book from day one. The go-to-market is focused, so early effort is not spread thinly.

Track	Focus at launch	Purpose
Consumers	One or two lead use cases (for example marketplace item pickups and small moves)	Volume and brand awareness
Businesses	A handful of anchor SMBs (for example furniture stores, florists), handled personally	Steady base work so drivers stay active
Later	Business tools such as invoicing and subscriptions	Added once repeat-use patterns are clear

Why this mix: Consumers book rarely, and businesses are slower to win but book often. Each covers the other's weakness.
Risks of this approach:

- RISK: Two audiences can split effort, budget and support. The focus rules above exist to limit this.
- RISK: Consumers need simple sign-up and trust signals, while businesses need records and repeat booking. Product decisions will sometimes pull in different directions.
- RISK: Consumer acquisition costs are usually high, and first-time users are handing items to a stranger.

5. Business model

- Type: Two-sided marketplace (customers and independent drivers), open to all customers at launch, with a focused go-to-market (see Section 4).
- Primary revenue: Commission on each job, taken from the job price. ASSUMPTION: a range such as 15-25% to be tested, not fixed.
- Possible later revenue: Business subscriptions (lower commission plus tools), add-on fees (extra helper, stairs), and priority or scheduled booking.
- Pricing: Not final. Earlier figures were first-pass placeholders. Pricing will be rebuilt from real job types, driver cost per hour and per km, and the commission needed to cover costs. This is covered in Document 3 (Unit Economics).

Price drivers to model: vehicle type, distance, time, item size and weight, helper required, stairs or lifts, waiting time, time of day, urgency.

6. Driver model: how supply works

Drivers are independent contractors: they apply, are verified, and choose which jobs to accept.
RISK: Not paying drivers a wage does not remove the supply problem. It changes it. The platform still needs enough drivers online in the right place and time, or customers get no match and leave. Early on, supply must still be actively attracted and activated (for example through targeted sign-ups in the launch area and guaranteed-earnings incentives for early jobs). This is the classic marketplace cold-start problem.
RISK: Contractor status carries legal obligations (see Section 9).

7. Competition (researched; full detail in Document 2)

Group	Examples	Key finding
Courier platforms	Zoom2u, GoPeople, Sherpa	Zoom2u and GoPeople say they already offer bike-to-truck vehicle choice, and Zoom2u and Sherpa also serve individuals (company claims)
Consumer apps	Uber Connect	Limited to a car boot, 20 kg and items under $100; cannot move bulky goods
Task marketplaces	Airtasker	Visible Melbourne demand for couch and small moves, but quote-and-negotiate
Status quo	Van operators, friends, Marketplace pickup groups	Fragmented
Not found in Australia	Lalamove	No evidence of Australian operation; possible future entrant

FACT: "Delivers anything, any size" is not a unique position.
OPPORTUNITY (hypothesis): An instant, fixed, all-in price for specific bulky-item jobs (for example a Marketplace purchase or small move) for consumers. This is not yet proven and must be tested against real competitor quotes.
RECOMMENDATION: Position around a specific job, not "deliver anything".

8. MVP concept

Core hypothesis: Customers will book and rebook mixed-size deliveries through a platform, and enough independent drivers will reliably fulfil them.
In MVP:

- One launch corridor (suggested: Footscray, CBD, Richmond)
- Two to three vehicle classes (bike/car, van/ute; trucks to be decided)
- Customer: book, quote, pay by card or wallet, track, photo proof, receipt; simple sign-up with minimal steps
- Business customers: same booking flow, with business name and ABN on receipts (full invoicing is post-MVP)
- Driver: apply and verify, accept job, navigate, capture proof, view earnings
- Admin: manual dispatch override, driver verification, dispute handling

Not in MVP: surge pricing, subscriptions, enterprise API, recurring scheduled jobs, quick commerce.

RECOMMENDATION: Run a manual pilot before full build (booking form, human dispatch, simple payments) to test demand and pricing cheaply.

9. Key risks (accepted, not yet addressed)

#	Risk	Work needed
1	Supply and cold start: too few drivers at the right time	Launch-area plan, incentives, utilisation model
2	Unit economics: thin margin on small jobs	Rebuild pricing from job types (Document 3)
3	Regulation: a Fair Work Commission gig-worker order has been in force since 17 Aug 2026 for food, drink and grocery delivery; orders covering last-mile delivery are under consideration	Legal advice on Australian and Victorian requirements (see Document 2, Section 5)
4	Liability: damage, no-shows, disputes, goods in transit	Insurance structure and terms of service
5	Disintermediation: repeat customers and drivers go off-platform	Tools and subscriptions that keep value on-platform
6	Budget: spending too much before validation	Staged funding tied to milestones
7	Consumer frequency and acquisition cost: low repeat rate, costly to acquire	Choose lead use cases, test referral and local channels, model customer lifetime value
8	Split focus: serving two audiences thins effort and budget	Limit launch to one or two consumer use cases plus a few anchor SMBs

10. Assumptions to validate

1. SMBs and individuals will pay a platform fee for convenience and transparency.
2. Enough drivers with suitable vehicles will join and stay active in one corridor.
3. Instant pricing can be accurate enough to protect both driver pay and platform margin.
4. Insurance can be arranged at a cost the pricing can carry.
5. Customers will not bypass the platform after the first few jobs.
6. Enough consumers will book often enough, or at high enough value, to keep drivers busy.
7. A handful of anchor SMBs can provide steady base work for drivers.

11. Open questions

1. Launch focus: which consumer jobs lead (marketplace pickups, small moves, forgotten items, parcels), and which business types become the first anchor accounts?
2. Trucks in MVP? They raise job value but also compliance, insurance, and loading complexity.

3. Launch area: is the Footscray, CBD, Richmond corridor right?
4. Pilot first or build first?
5. Funding: the earlier $1.2M seed and $650K team figures are treated as placeholders until confirmed.

12. Parked ideas (kept separate)

- Blinkit-style shop-and-deliver: a runner buys items for the customer.
- Multi-ethnic grocery quick commerce: partnered Indian, Asian, and Middle Eastern grocers with fast delivery.

These are different businesses from each other. The Porter driver network and tech may be reused later, but they should not shape the MVP. They will be saved in a separate file.

13. Next documents

1. Parked-ideas file
2. Competitive and market analysis (researched, cited)
3. Business model canvas and unit economics
4. MVP definition and risk register
5. PRD and developer handoff
1.